BELGRAVE CONSULTANCY

ERP Implementation

Readiness Scorecard

FREE ASSESSMENT TOOL

Score your readiness!

How to use this scorecard

Score each dimension honestly from 1 to 5. Complete it independently (managing director, operations lead and finance lead), then compare your scores dimension by dimension. Significant differences between scores are as informative as the scores themselves.

Total your score out of 35 and read your readiness tier at the end.

Scoring guide

1	Not in place / not considered
2	Early thinking only / significant gaps
3	Partially in place/work still needed
4	Largely in place / minor gaps remaining
5	Fully in place / confident and complete

1 Dimension 1 — Process Clarity

Can your business describe how it operates, step by step, in a way that an informed outsider could understand?

Score	What it looks like	Your score
1	No process documentation exists. Processes live in people's heads.	___ / 5
2	Some informal notes exist, but are incomplete and inconsistent.	___ / 5
3	Key processes are partially documented. Core flows exist but lack detail, RASCI, or agreed boundaries.	___ / 5
4	Most core processes are documented. Minor gaps or outdated sections remain.	___ / 5
5	All core processes documented to procedure level (scope, flowchart, narrative, RASCI, related documents) and reviewed within the last 12 months.	___ / 5

Why this matters: Without process clarity, your requirements phase will be consumed by internal debate. In my experience, businesses with documented processes complete requirements in roughly half the time of those without. PMI reports inadequate requirements gathering as the primary cause of project failure in 39% of organisations. → See Chapter 3 of the guide.

2 Dimension 2 — Objective Clarity

Does your leadership team have a clear, shared, honest answer to the question: why are we really doing this?

Score	What it looks like	Your score
1	No clear objective beyond "we need a better system." Different people would give different answers.	___ / 5
2	A general direction exists, but objectives are vague, unmeasured, or not agreed upon across leadership.	___ / 5
3	Objectives are broadly agreed but not specific or measurable.	___ / 5
4	Clear objectives are defined and agreed upon. Most leaders could articulate them consistently.	___ / 5
5	Specific, measurable objectives are defined, agreed upon, and documented. Everyone can articulate why this is happening and what success looks like.	___ / 5

Why this matters: "We need a better system" is not a strategy. Without clear objectives, there is no basis for evaluating system fit or measuring success. → See Chapter 4.

3 Dimension 3 — Leadership Commitment

Is there a named individual at a senior level whose commitment is attached to the success of this project, in active engagement, not just approval?

Score	What it looks like	Your score
1	No project owner identified. Accountability is shared, which in practice means it belongs to no one.	___ / 5
2	A name has been discussed but not formally confirmed. The person is unaware of what the role requires.	___ / 5
3	A project owner is identified, but their authority is limited or their time is already stretched.	___ / 5
4	A credible project owner with appropriate authority is in place. Leadership engagement could be more consistent.	___ / 5
5	The named project owner confirmed with clear authority, appropriate time allocation, and visible commitment from the top.	___ / 5

Why this matters: In Prosci's research, 79% of projects with extremely effective sponsors met their objectives, against 27% with extremely ineffective sponsors. Without it, decisions stall and resistance goes unchallenged. → See Chapter 4 of the guide.

4 Dimension 4 — Internal Capacity

Does your business have the people, with the right knowledge and sufficient availability, to run this project properly alongside normal operations?

Score	What it looks like	Your score
1	No internal resources identified. Everyone is fully committed to current operations.	___ / 5
2	People informally discussed, but no time was formally allocated.	___ / 5
3	Some capacity was identified, but it is insufficient. Key people would be significantly stretched.	___ / 5
4	The core project team was identified with meaningful time allocated. Some gaps remain.	___ / 5
5	The project team confirmed with a realistic time allocation. Responsibilities adjusted or backfilled where needed.	___ / 5

Why this matters: Internal staff time is typically at least as large as the vendor fees, and in demanding projects considerably larger. This is the most consistently underestimated cost in any implementation. → See Chapter 4 of the guide.

5 Dimension 5 — Data Quality

Do you know the state of your current data, and is it clean enough to migrate without first becoming a crisis?

Score	What it looks like	Your score
1	No assessment of current data has been done. Data quality is unknown or poor.	___ / 5
2	Data quality was discussed but not formally assessed. Known problems have not been addressed.	___ / 5
3	A basic data audit has been done. Significant work remains, particularly in master data.	___ / 5
4	Data quality has been formally assessed, and a migration plan is in development. Most master data is clean or has a remediation plan in place.	___ / 5
5	Master data is clean, validated, and ready for migration. A formal migration plan exists with test cycles planned.	___ / 5

Why this matters: Data migration is consistently the most underestimated workload. Poor data in a new system does not improve. → See Chapter 9.

6 Dimension 6 — Budget Realism

Has your business built a complete and honest budget, accounting for vendor costs, internal time, data migration, training, contingency, and the inevitable surprises?

Score	What it looks like	Your score
1	No budget beyond the vendor quote. The vendor estimate has been accepted at face value.	___ / 5
2	A budget exists based primarily on vendor estimates. No contingency. Minimal internal costs accounted for.	___ / 5
3	A broader budget has been developed. Some internal costs are included. Contingency present but possibly insufficient.	___ / 5
4	A realistic budget was built, including vendor costs, internal staff time, data migration, and training. At least 15% contingency.	___ / 5
5	Complete, independently validated budget. Internal time cost is explicitly stated. 15–20% contingency. Leadership has approved the full realistic number.	___ / 5

Why this matters: Overruns are common: large IT projects average 45% over budget (McKinsey/Oxford). Typical ERP durations are 9–18 months from kick-off to go-live; Panorama reported a median of 9 months in 2025. → See Chapter 4 of the guide.

7 Dimension 7 — Change Readiness

Is your organisation (not just leadership, but the people who will use the system) prepared for the disruption of a major system change?

Score	What it looks like	Your score
1	No thought given to change management. The plan is to announce and train before go-live.	___ / 5
2	Awareness that change management matters, but no plan exists. Communication has not started.	___ / 5
3	Some change management thinking is in place. Communication has begun, but is inconsistent.	___ / 5
4	A change management approach is defined. Communication plan in place. Key internal champions identified.	___ / 5
5	Active change management is underway. Champions engaged. Training built around real roles and scenarios. Leadership is visibly championing the change.	___ / 5

Why this matters: Prosci research: 88% of projects with excellent change management met or exceeded their objectives, against 13% with poor change management. → See Chapter 10 of the guide.

Your total score across all 7 dimensions:	___ / 35

What your score means

29–35	**Ready to start** Your business has done the hard work. Proceed with vendor conversations and use the guide to avoid the common traps. Reassess if significant time passes or key people change.
20–28	**Prepare first** Meaningful progress has been made, but gaps remain. Identify your lowest-scoring dimensions. Reassess before committing to a vendor.
12–19	**Significant work needed** Starting from this position carries real risk. The work needed is mostly internal, but it must happen before the project begins.
Below 12	**Stop and regroup** This is not the moment to start an implementation. An honest answer now is worth considerably more than an expensive lesson eighteen months from now.

Want to turn your score into a plan?

The Software Is Not the Problem gives you the complete framework, from process mapping through go-live and beyond. Written from the business side, not the vendor's.

Get the guide: www.belgraveconsultancy.com/guide/

Belgrave Consultancy — *The Software Is Not the Problem*